

Appendix B: Export Plan



Beex

EST 2022



THE
COMPANY

inholland

International Boardroom:

Export Plan Report 2022 - 2023

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Introduction

Exporting a business to a new market can be a complex and challenging process, requiring careful planning and strategy to ensure success. This report aims to provide a comprehensive overview of the steps that a company, Beex, can take to successfully export its business to the Belgian market in 2023. The main research question is how Beex can achieve this export successfully, and the sub-questions cover various aspects of the business plan and strategy, including the business plan and export strategy, earning model and value creation, operational plan, marketing objectives, and marketing mix. The report is based on a combination of desk and field research, including both qualitative and quantitative elements, and various models are used to analyze the data. The strategic choice of exporting to Belgium is based on opportunities such as expanding international prospects and networks, identifying a new source of revenue, and improving corporate social responsibility efforts. Cultural differences and challenges are also considered in the business plan and strategy. The goal of this report is to provide a comprehensive analysis of the key considerations and steps that Beex should take to successfully export its business to Belgium in 2023.

I. Problem Statement and Analysis

The purpose of this chapter is to analyze the feasibility of exporting the business of Beex to the Belgian market in 2023. To do so, we will begin by providing a summary of the client pitch that took place on November 2nd, 2022, in which Beex was presented with the selected export country. The main research question that will guide this study is: "How can BEEX successfully export its business to the Belgian market in the year 2023?" To address this question, we have formulated several sub-questions that will focus on different aspects of Beex's business plan and strategy, earning model and value creation, operational plan, marketing objectives, and marketing mix. The research methods employed in this study include both desk and field research, as well as the use of various models and tools to support our analysis. The findings of this study will be presented in the conclusion, along with recommendations for Beex as they consider exporting their business to Belgium in 2023.

I.I. Problem Sketch: Client Pitch – November 2nd, 2022

Beex, among teachers of the InHolland University of Applied sciences, was presented with the chosen export country by our team. Our presentation consisted of an introduction to the team and mission, a SWOT analysis of Beex, listing the selection criteria we used, and the various candidate countries while indicating why they were chosen and why they were not, based on desk research. Furthermore, we listed the supported justifications for selecting Belgium as an export destination in terms of location, language, quality of life, competition, and the PR and social media industries' growth. Bieke van Orten, the CEO of the company, expressed her approval of our selection. Some of the feedback we have received was that the client is curious to learn more about potential new clients in Belgium, any potential drawbacks of exporting, and which specific city in Belgium is best for exporting.

I.II. Main Question and Sub-questions

Main research question:

How can BEEX successfully export its business to the Belgian market in the year 2023?

Sub-questions:

- 1) What will BEEX's business plan and export strategy be, considering the strategic choice of exporting into Belgium, the cultural differences, challenges, and opportunities, as well as the CSR trends in the export country in 2023?
- 2) How will BEEX's earning model and value creation be impacted by the export to Belgium in 2023?
- 3) What is BEEX's ideal operational plan, including internal organization, legal aspects, and CSR strategies to realize the export into Belgium in 2023?
- 4) Which SMART marketing objectives will BEEX's export plan include, and how will they align with the export strategy for 2023?
- 5) What will BEEX's export marketing mix look like, according to the 5P's of Marketing, in the year 2023

I.III. Research Method

Desk- and field research make up the majority of the research methodology presented in the report. Qualitative research is carried out according to feedback from our client and the teachers during the pitch presentation held on the 2nd of November 2022. A variety of diverse models, including Ansoff Growth Matrix, Hofstede, 3Ps of CSR and others such as for the revenue model are used to conduct quantitative research. Answers to the sub- and central questions are concluded in chapter VI. Conclusion of the report. Each chapter of the report was the subject of research by the team members, and the various findings were combined to achieve a comprehensive report on every component discussed.

II. Business Plan and Strategy

This chapter will provide a detailed analysis of the strategic choice of exporting to Belgium and the opportunities and challenges that Beex may face in this market. The decision to export Beex's business to Belgium in 2023 was based on a variety of opportunities and considerations. These include the opportunity to expand Beex's international prospects and networks, identify sources of revenue, and improve corporate social responsibility efforts. The strategic choice of exporting to Belgium was also influenced by cultural differences and challenges, as well as the growth of the PR and social media industries in Belgium. To successfully export to Belgium, Beex will need to carefully plan and strategize, including developing a business plan and export strategy that takes into account these considerations.

II.1. Strategic Choice: Belgium

Opportunities

As mentioned in the organizational report for Beex, working with more clients abroad would be an opportunity for Beex to take advantage of expanding its international prospects and possible future collaborations. Additionally, through this, the business would be able to expand its networks and connections abroad in case they ever decide to export its services elsewhere.

Furthermore, identifying an additional source of revenue for the business and working on Beex's CSR efforts as it is a great opportunity to take advantage of because it is becoming increasingly important for firms to prioritize CSR as it may assist in staff recruitment and retention, improve how customers perceive Beex as a brand, and demonstrate investor accountability (Heyward, 2020). Finally, another opportunity is standing out from Beex's competitors as it allows Beex to create and maintain its reputation as a brand, increase sales, and stays relevant to its customers and industry (Jaiswal, 2022).

Ansoff Growth Matrix

The Ansoff growth matrix can help Beex to identify potential growth opportunities and choose the best strategy to pursue based on its resources, capabilities, and risk tolerance (Agnello, 2020). For example, if Beex wants to focus on expanding its reach within its existing market, it could consider market penetration strategies such as increasing its marketing efforts or offering new pricing packages to its existing clients. On the other hand, if Beex is interested in entering a new market with its existing products, it could consider market development strategies such as identifying new distribution channels or partnerships in the target market. It is important to carefully evaluate the potential risks and rewards of each growth strategy before deciding on a course of action.



Competitors

As for competition, there is room for Beex to export its services as many companies in the domain of PR, Digital Marketing and Content Marketing are relatively similar to Beex such as Pure Black Studios, LM agency, Pop Productions, 148 Studios, Backstage Communication, Just Like U studios, and Luna communication agency (Sortlist, 2022).

As mentioned in the briefing, exporting Beex is not currently a priority for the company right now (Personal communication client, 2022). Hence, we chose a country nearby which makes traveling easy, less than 3 hours long.

The quality of life is significantly high in Belgium. According to a study by Wharton School, Pennsylvania, Belgium scored a total of 81.8 on being a good job market, economic stability, and political stability (Wharton, 2021).

Criteria

Based on the previous SWOT analysis we came up with criteria to find out the perfect export country for Beex. Some of these include: The country must be in the EU. Has a growing PR industry. Must be Dutch or English speaking.

Furthermore, the country must have large social media and digital marketing activities, political and economic stability, and last but not least reasonable office rent and energy costs.

PR in Belgium

It is projected that the revenue of public relations will amount to more than 2 million US dollars by 2025 (Statista, 2022). This is an indication that the PR industry is constantly growing in Belgium which is excellent for Beex as PR is one of the services they offer.

Social Media in Belgium

Beex helps its clients with branding and digital marketing. According to a study in 2021, Belgium scored a total of 74% in the share of enterprises using social networks in the European Union (Statista, 2021). This is yet another indication that social media activities are on the rise making Belgium the perfect candidate for export.

Belgium was already mentioned in the initial BEEX briefing, according to Beex Bieke, the CEO (Personal communication client, 2022). We concur with her assessment that Belgium is under-represented in many markets, which gives them an even greater opportunity to dominate the Belgian market and propel it to the same level of success as other European countries (Statista, 2021).

II. II. Cultural Aspects

Geert Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions Theory is a framework used to understand cultural differences across countries and to discern how business is done across different cultures (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022). The framework discusses the following elements: Individualism, Power Distance, Masculinity, Uncertainty Avoidance, Long-Term Orientation, and Indulgence. (For more information on this model see Appendix)

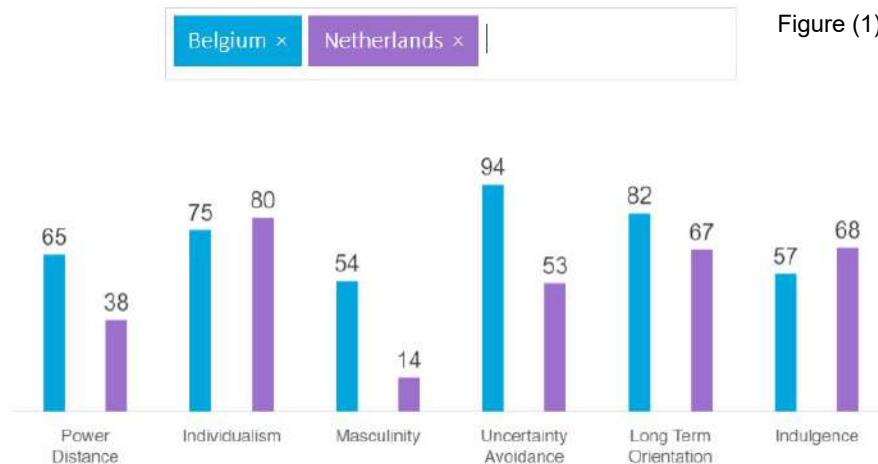


Figure (1)

The following can be seen in the figure above (1); Individualism is estimated to be almost the same in Belgium and the Netherlands, even though the Netherlands scores lower on Power Distance. Belgium has a higher level of Masculinity. Belgium has a higher level of Uncertainty Avoidance. There isn't much of a difference between Long-Term Orientation and Indulgence.

As a result, this model may be advantageous for Beex's entry into CSR because it is more adaptable and the company can carry it out however best suits them.

The following are some drawbacks to the 3Ps model: It might be more challenging to evaluate non-financial inputs or outputs such as the difficulty of measuring certain social and environmental. Additionally, there may be an absence of comparability among impact groups (i.e., companies may need to choose one of the Ps over the other) (Kenton, 2022). However, the latter may be of benefit to Beex, as they may choose to focus on one of the Ps as a starting point for CSR. In conclusion, the 3Ps model is more suitable for Beex's start in CSR efforts.

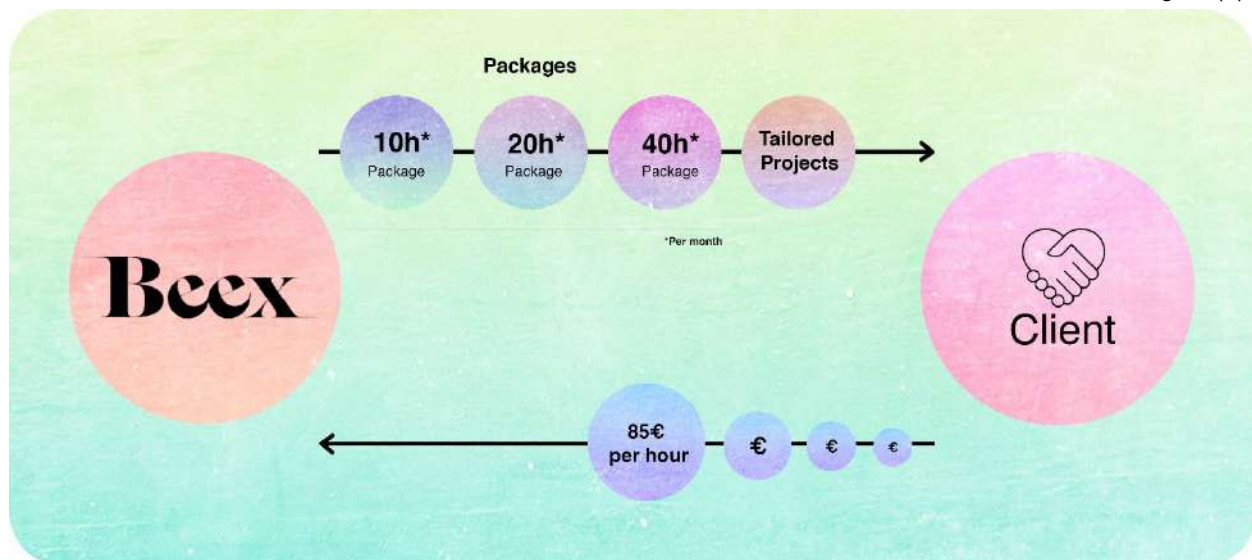
II. III. Revenue Model

The method for managing a company's revenue streams and the resources needed for each revenue stream is called a revenue model (The Founder Institute, 2018). As mentioned in the SWOT analysis in Beex's organizational report, the current revenue model of the company is one of its strengths as it helps the business stand out from the competition; as a result, Beex should continue to use the same model for its export in Belgium. The current revenue model used by Beex is the subscription model. The subscription revenue model entails providing clients with a product or service that they can pay for overtime, usually month to month or even year to year (The Founder Institute, 2018).

The subscriptions consist of three-monthly packages/subscriptions which cost 85 € per hour as listed on Beex's website (Beex, 2022) as follows (Figure 2):

- Cool Start aka "Mooie Start" consists of 10 hours per month.
- Ready for Growth aka "Klaar voor Groei" consisting of 20 hours per month.
- Strive for Gold! aka "Ga voor Goud!" consisting of 40 hours per month.

Figure (2)



There is also the option of requesting a customized project package if the client is unsure which type of subscription/package to select; Beex creates custom projects that are tailored to the client's needs as stated on their website (Beex, 2022).

The subscription model's primary business benefit is that it allows brands to establish recurring relationships with customers (Johnson, 2022). In research from Johnson, a creative business writer, and industry insights blogger (2022), the following are some of the advantages of the subscription model for the clients and the business, reliable recurring revenue, strong client base and increased customer loyalty, easier financial forecasting, increased LTV (Customer lifetime value), and reduced churn, by making their subscription offerings flexible and better customer retention. However, the subscription revenue model also has some threats for instance, as this revenue model has started to gain popularity, many businesses may take the opportunity to develop such a model for their business, therefore, increasing the risk of competition (Ludin, 2021).

II. IV. Value Creation

Investment

Based on the financial plan we developed for Beex, we determined that having a physical office in Belgium is of high importance. The physical representation of a company communicates its identity, ethos, and values. The physical office may enhance how customers perceive a business as it serves as the focal point where stakeholders, clients, potential new employees, and even members of the press can physically experience a brand (Signify Digital, 2022). Furthermore, according to Robin Weckesser, president of a3 Workplace Strategies, a San Jose-based workplace solutions consulting firm in the United States and around the world (2022), having a physical office promotes professional development by facilitating better collaboration, making in-person communication simpler and more efficient, and promotes greater production. Additionally, there are startup costs associated with registering Beex with the Belgian Chamber of Commerce with the help of a notary. Beex has the option to invest in new computers in addition to other inventory items such as desks, screens, and other furniture, among other things.

The various investment items and their estimated total values are shown in the figure below (3) which depicts a bank loan, office rental, startup costs; a notary and a chamber of commerce registration, two computers; a MacBook Pro 13” and an iMac 24”, and an inventory list consisting of desks, couch, screens, camera lights, printer, storage closet among others.

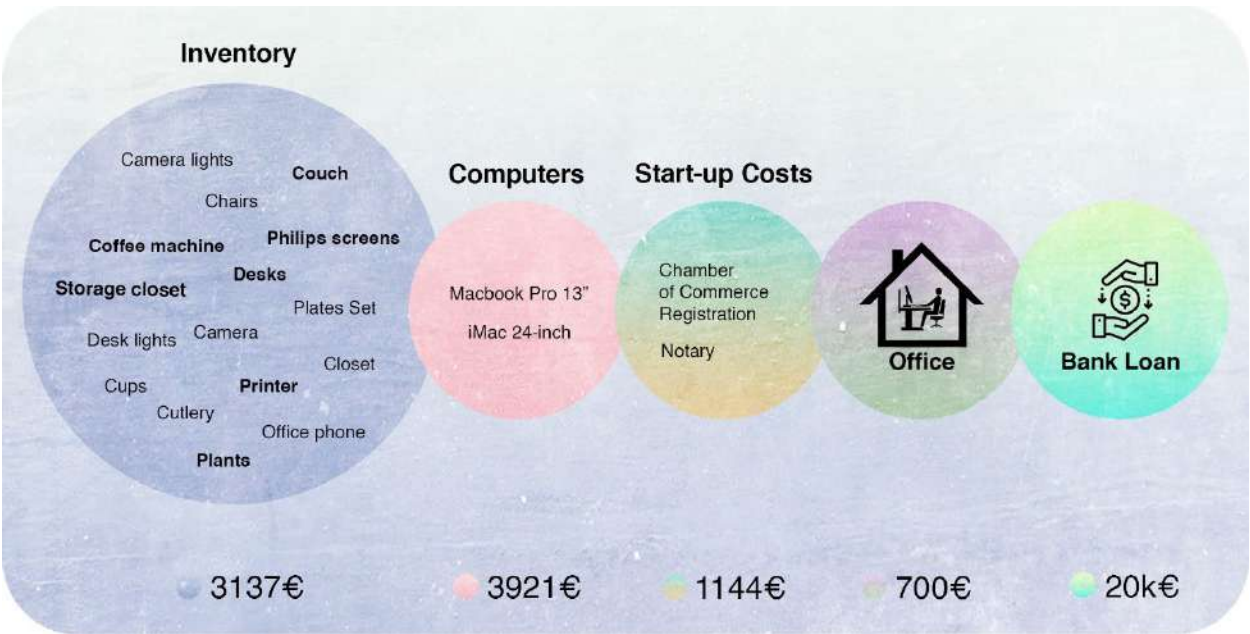


Figure (3)

Costs

The costs for Beex in their first year in Belgium include depreciation, business costs, and salaries. Depreciation occurs when the value of a business asset decreases over time (Warnes, 2022). The depreciations apply to items in the inventory on the list previously mentioned. The business costs consist of office rent, a variety of subscriptions, and bank interest of 7.45 percent. The salaries are for a manager and an intern assistant. Each cost component is broken down into three categories alongside the total values per year in figure (4).

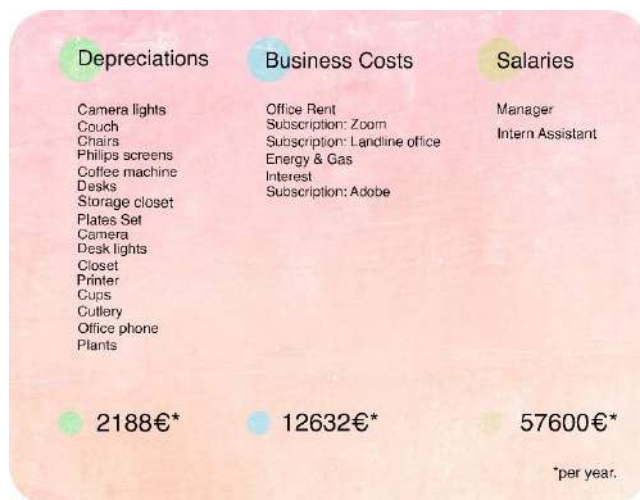


Figure (4)

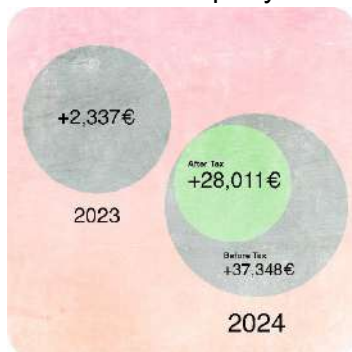


Figure (5)

Turnover and Profit

The company is estimated to make a profit of **+2,337€** in its first year in Belgium in 2023. It is quite common for a startup business to not make a high profit in its first year. “99% of startup businesses I work with make a loss in year one” (Crawford, 2019). Less profit means that the company pays no tax, and it is carried forward onto the following years’ accounts to save even more money on tax (Crawford, 2019). As for 2024, the company is estimated to have **+37,348€** gross income and **+28,011€** after taxation (see figure 5).

Alternatively, we developed a substitute financing strategy aka “plan B” with lower costs and a projected profit. The plan consists of renting shared/virtual office space with a manager and an intern assistant. Furthermore, Beex would remain using the same equipment they currently have such as computers and other items. By executing this plan, Beex will have the option of working with their current team and office in The Netherlands in addition to the employees in their shared/virtual office in Belgium. Figure (6) depicts the estimated investment/costs and profit for the alternative plan.



Figure (6)

Please note that all amounts mentioned in the sections; “Investment”, “Costs” and “Turnover and Profit” are estimations based on research as there are no solid guarantees that can be made.

II.V. Corporate Social Responsibility

Beex's CEO, Bieke van Orten, stated that while they have not yet invested in CSR, it is definitely on their agenda for 2024. (Personal communication client, 2022). This chapter discusses the 3Ps and Carroll's CSR Pyramid concerning Belgium, along with substantiation.

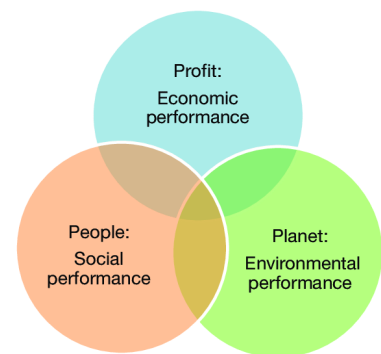


The pyramid of corporate social responsibility, created in 1979 by Archie Carroll, is a four-tiered manual for self-regulation of business morals and ethics (Winterberg, 2022). The four tiers are as follows; Economic Responsibility, Legal Responsibility, Ethical Responsibility, and Philanthropic Responsibility.

This model may be a little too demanding for Beex as they are just starting in CSR because it has a lot of obligations, which could be overwhelming for them. Furthermore, Carroll's pyramid of CSR contains an implicit hierarchy of responsibilities, which Kang and Wood (1995) criticize, contending that this hierarchy

increases the likelihood that social welfare will be sacrificed for economic gain (Baden, 2016).

The Triple Bottom Line, or 3Ps model, is an additional CSR framework that measures a company's overall social and environmental impact across the three Ps of People, Planet, and Planet (Winterberg, 2022). The term "triple bottom line" was coined in 1994 by renowned British management consultant and sustainability expert John Elkington as his method of gauging performance in corporate America. The concept was that a business could be run so that it not only generates profits but also enhances the lives of its customers and the environment (Kenton, 2022). According to research by Kenton (2022), when assessing the 3Ps, businesses may need to think outside the box. The way a company must record its accounting profit is clearly outlined by traditional accounting rules. In contrast, there might be little to no structure in place for how a business must measure its 3Ps, especially if there is no need for external reporting. As a result, this model may be advantageous for Beex's entry into CSR because it is more adaptable and the company can carry it out however best suits them.



The following are some drawbacks to the 3Ps model: It might be more challenging to evaluate non-financial inputs or outputs such as the difficulty of measuring certain social and environmental. Additionally, there may be an absence of comparability among impact groups (i.e., companies may need to choose one of the Ps over the other) (Kenton, 2022). However, the latter may also be advantageous to Beex, as they may choose to focus on one of the Ps as a starting point for CSR. In conclusion, the 3Ps model is more suitable for Beex's start in CSR.

III. Operational Plan

In this chapter, we will focus on the internal organization of Beex as they prepare to export their business to Belgium in 2023. This includes the personnel and resources that will be deployed, such as employees, office and equipment, and communication strategies. We will also examine the legal implications of establishing and operating a business in Belgium, including entity establishment, employment law, and intellectual property. Furthermore, we will take a look at how Beex's CSR strategy will look in Belgium.

III. I. Internal Organization

Employees

The team will have two employees: a manager and an assistant. Beex may also seek assistance from their current team in the Netherlands. Beex will continue to hire freelancers in the same way that they are currently doing as it is working for them.

Figure (7)

Office, Equipment, and Personnel

The office will be located in Antwerp based on the client's request (Personal communication client, 2022). Figure (7) depicts a list of items that Beex would require for their export plan to Belgium.

Values

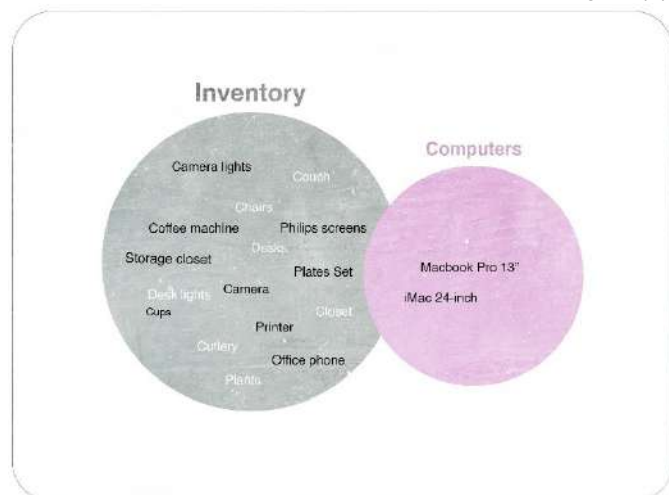
Beex's organizational values are personal attention, flexibility, and a commitment to quality in all that they deliver. Their most popular package is the 20-hour subscription which costs between € 1500 and € 1800. On average, they have 10 customers per month who purchase this package. In addition to this package, they also offer separate projects and smaller packages, as well as a single larger package of 30 or 40 hours.

Monthly Activities

In terms of Beex's monthly activities, they create social media calendars for their customers during the last week of each month. They also send out monthly mailings to their clients, which can range from one to four times per month. Additionally, they hold a monthly meeting with each customer to discuss their needs and goals.

Weekly Activities

Weekly, they maintain contact with their customers to discuss current activities, social media posts, design work, printed materials, and influencer activities. Beex also frequently conducts photo and video shoots, either on location or at their office, for both products and models. These projects are almost always undertaken weekly for all of Beex's customers.



III. II. Legal Implications

The information in this sub-chapter is derived from a report on the legality of establishing a business in Belgium by Deloitte (2022) a legal firm with offices in both Belgium and the Netherlands, and MUL Law Offices (2020), a law firm that offers corporate and commercial services to foreign clients in Belgium.

Belgium's legal system is a civil law legal system founded on acts of parliament, decrees, royal decrees, executive orders, harmonized European Union law as it applies to member states, and international law.

Entity Establishment

In Belgium, there are two main types of business structures, a limited liability company (also known as a "besloten vennootschap" or "société à responsabilité limitée") limits the liability of its shareholders to the amount of their investment. It is distinguished by its flexibility and has no minimum capital requirement.

The open limited liability company (also known as a "naamloze vennootschap" or "société anonyme") limits the liability of its shareholders to the amount of their investment. The most popular legal structure for public companies in Belgium, it has a minimum capital requirement and free transferability of shares is the norm.

As of 2022, Beex in the Netherlands is a limited liability company (Personal communication client, 2022).

Employment

Employees hired in Belgium under a Belgian employment contract are subject to Belgian employment law. The essential rights and protections provided by Belgian employment law to employees are listed in the table below. (Table 1)

Right / Protection	Description
National Minimum Wage	In Belgium, the minimum wage is not set by the law, but by collective bargaining agreements (CBA) concluded at the industry level. An overall minimum wage is set by the national CBA 43 determining the "guaranteed average monthly income" (GAMI). However, in most cases, collective bargaining agreements have been concluded at the industry level providing for a minimum wage higher than the minimum wage fixed by the national CBA 43. The GAMI for full-time employees amounts to € 1,806.16 (as of 1 April 2022).
Working Hours	Working hours are strictly regulated in Belgium, including, among other laws, the Law of 16 March 1971, which imposes a

	maximum working week of 38 hours and a maximum working day of eight hours. However, under specific conditions, employees are permitted to exceed the maximum specified in the Law of 16 March 1971 or by industry CBAs by working overtime.
Rest Periods	Unless an exemption applies, employees are entitled to the following rest periods: • 11 hours of uninterrupted rest per day; • 24 hours of uninterrupted rest on Sunday; and • A rest break of 15 minutes when working more than six hours per day (unless a rest period is already determined by a CBA or a Royal Decree). • Where exemptions apply, compensatory rest will usually have to be given.
Holiday	Paid holiday entitlements are based on the number of days worked for the current or previous employer in the year before the year in which the paid holiday is taken. An employee who works five days a week and worked for all 12 months of the previous year has a statutory right to 20 days of paid holiday. Belgian employees are further entitled to 10 paid public holidays.
Maternity Leave / Pay	Employees are entitled to take up to 15 weeks of maternity leave (17 weeks or 19 weeks in case of multiple births). Employees are entitled to a maternity allowance paid by Public Health Insurance: • For the first 30 days, employees will receive 82% of their normal gross salary uncapped; and • From the 31st day and in the event of an extension, employees will receive 75% of their normal gross salary capped. Employees who take maternity leave are protected against dismissal. The employee may only be dismissed for reasons unrelated to the maternity leave. If this protection is not observed, the termination of the employment contract will be considered unlawful. The employer will

	then be liable to pay compensation in place of notice as well as a lump-sum redundancy payment equivalent to six month's salary. These two indemnities can, in principle, be cumulated.
Paternity Leave	Eligible employees are entitled to take up to 15 days of paternity leave (20 days from 1 January 2023). Employees are entitled to a paternity allowance: • In the first three days, employees will receive their normal gross salary fully paid by the employer; and • In the following days, employees will receive a paternity allowance paid by Public Health Insurance, equivalent to 82% of their normal gross salary. Employees who take paternity leave are protected against dismissal. The employee may only be dismissed for reasons unrelated to the paternity leave. If this protection is not observed, the termination of the employment contract will be considered unlawful. The employer will then be liable to pay compensation instead of notice as well as a lump-sum redundancy payment equivalent to six month's salary. These two indemnities can, in principle, be cumulated.

Table (1)

Tax

A company with its primary place of business in Belgium is subject to corporate income tax on its worldwide profits, including capital gains, less any allowable deductions. All business expenses may be deducted by companies when determining their taxable income, provided that they are legitimate (i.e., incurred or borne to obtain or retain taxable income) and are not expressly prohibited by Belgian domestic tax regulations. They must also relate to the taxable period, be supported by adequate documentation, and be legitimate (i.e., incurred or borne to obtain or retain taxable income). Different types of taxes are listed below.

- Corporate income tax. The standard rate of corporate income tax is 25 percent. If certain requirements are met, the first €100,000 of revenue for small and medium-sized businesses (SMEs) is subject to tax at a rate of 20%.
- Dividends. The default withholding tax rate on dividends paid to both residents and non-residents is 30%.
- Transfer tax. The transfer of real estate situated in Belgium is subject to transfer (or registration) taxes. The standard rate for businesses is either 12% or 12.5% as of 1 January 2022, depending on the area in which the property is located.

Intellectual Property



According to MUL Law Offices (2020), in Belgium, there are different ways of protecting intellectual property: the copyright and related rights, the patent, the trademark, the design or the model, and the PBR. These give their holders an exclusive right to the exploitation of their intellectual property in a limited area and for a limited time. The Belgian Office for Intellectual Property (OPRI) is the official body for the registration of trademarks and designs in the Benelux. Intellectual property in Belgium can be divided into two main categories: industrial property rights on the one hand and the rights of literary and artistic property on the other.

GDPR

The General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) is a European Union (EU) regulation that went into effect on May 25, 2018, and it replaces the 1995 EU Data Protection Directive and strengthens EU data protection rules by giving individuals more control over their personal data and establishing a single set of data protection rules that apply to all EU member states (Fraeyenhoven, 2022). In Belgium, the GDPR is implemented through national laws and regulations, such as the Belgian Data Protection Act of 30 July 2018 (Claeys, 2020). The Belgian Data Protection Authority (DPA) is responsible for enforcing the GDPR in Belgium, and under the GDPR, organizations that handle personal data of individuals in the EU must ensure that they protect the data from unauthorized access, use, disclosure, and destruction, and that they respect the data subjects' rights to control how their data is used (Stassen et al., 2022). This includes obtaining explicit consent for the collection, use, and sharing of personal data, and providing individuals with the right to access, correct, or erase their personal data.



III. III. CSR

As discussed in Chapter II.V. the 3Ps model is what Beex will implement when it comes to their CSR initiatives in the export country Belgium. The model also known as the triple bottom line, is a framework for measuring the sustainability of a business. The 3Ps refer to three key dimensions of sustainability: people, planet, and profit (Rinalducci, 2022). To implement this model Beex can ask for guidance from a CSR consulting firm such as Sarko, a consulting CSR firm that helps businesses build a sustainability strategy, define measurable goals, and develop related action plans (2022). Another company that Beex can use consultation from is CleanTechFlanders which



helps businesses with the implementation of clean technologies that accelerate the transition to a sustainable world (2022). Beex can work on its corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiatives by taking guidance from a CSR consulting firm as it can provide Beex expert guidance and support in developing and implementing CSR

initiatives that align with Beex's values and goals (Elango, 2021). The first step in partnering with a CSR consulting firm is to identify the specific areas in which Beex wants to focus its CSR efforts -in terms of people, planet, and profit- which could include reducing its environmental impact, supporting local communities, or promoting diversity and inclusion. Once the areas of focus have been identified, the CSR consulting firm can help Beex develop a comprehensive CSR strategy that outlines the specific initiatives that the business will undertake and the goals that it hopes to achieve. This strategy should be aligned with Beex's overall business objectives and should be designed to maximize the positive impact that the company can have on the world. The consulting firm can then guide how Beex should engage with stakeholders, such as employees, customers, and local communities, as well as help to develop and implement programs and initiatives that support Beex's CSR goals. In addition to providing guidance and support during the implementation phase, the consulting firm can also help the company measure and **evaluate** the impact of its CSR initiatives. This can include conducting research and analysis to assess the effectiveness of the initiatives and providing recommendations for improvement.

Another approach to implementing a CSR strategy for Beex would be to carefully choose clients in Antwerp that align with the company's sustainability goals, such as ESSENTIEL Antwerp, HNST, and la fille d'O (2022). These organizations are known for their focus on innovative, environmentally friendly products and commitment to diversity and equality initiatives.

The logo for ESSENTIEL ANTWERP features the word "ESSENTIEL" in a bold, sans-serif font, with "ANTWERP" in a smaller, all-caps font directly below it.The logo for hnst features the lowercase letters "hnst" in a bold, sans-serif font.The logo for la fille d'O features the words "la", "fille", and "d'O" stacked vertically in a bold, sans-serif font.

In conclusion, engaging with a CSR consulting firm and working with clients who prioritize CSR efforts may be an effective means for Beex to pursue its CSR goals and make a positive contribution to people, the planet, and profit.

IV. Marketing Plan

In this chapter, we will outline the marketing objectives of the marketing plan for Beex's export to Belgium. These objectives, which were developed using the SMART method, are focused on increasing brand awareness, establishing partnerships, improving customer satisfaction and retention, increasing website traffic, and expanding the company's social media presence. To achieve these objectives, we will recommend a variety of strategies, including targeted social media advertising, search engine optimization, and content marketing. Furthermore, a marketing mix is established with the product, price plan, promotion, and personnel. Finally, the legal and financial implications of the marketing plan are discussed.

IV.I. Marketing Objectives

The purpose of marketing objectives is to guide marketing efforts by outlining measurable goals for the results of a marketing strategy (Nasrudin, 2022). This section includes five marketing objectives (A - F) that were developed using the SMART method followed by in-depth descriptions. These objectives are aligned with the previously established strategy for Beex's export to Belgium and are focused on increasing sales and adapting Beex to the Belgian market.

A. Brand Awareness

Increase the overall brand awareness for the company in Belgium by 30% within the first six months of export to Belgium through **targeted social media advertising**.

As mentioned in the organizational report previously developed for Beex, the company's target audience is mainly lifestyle, fashion, and catering industry companies. To increase brand awareness, the campaign should focus on creating content that resonates with the target audience and encourages engagement and sharing. In research from Kondak, a targeted advertisement in online marketing is one that is shown to a particular audience, which could be a demographic, a group, or an individual. Targeted advertising can simply mean that ads are chosen with the assumption that they will also be relevant to the site's audience based on their relevance to the site's content (2022). According to Beex's website, the company is currently using Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn for social media channels (Beex, 2022). Facebook and Instagram are great platforms for targeted advertising as they have numerous targeting options and would help Beex to determine the most accurate picture of its target market (Kondak, 2022).

This objective can be measured by social media management tools

B. Clients & Partnerships

Establish partnerships with at least three key industry players in Belgium in 2023 to increase brand visibility and **reach potential clients**.

As mentioned in the opportunities in Beex's organizational report, working with more clients abroad would be an opportunity for Beex to take advantage of expanding its international prospects and possible future collaborations. Partnerships can be a valuable way for businesses to attract new clients and by partnering with other companies or organizations, businesses can access new networks and customer bases, as well as gain credibility and support for their products or services (Malla, 2021). In some cases, partnerships can also lead to cost savings and other benefits that can help a business to grow and thrive (Sumner, 2021). Overall, partnerships can be an effective way for businesses to expand their reach and attract new clients.

C. Customer Satisfaction and Retention Rates

Increase customer satisfaction and retention rates in 2023 in Belgium by delivering high-quality design and content for clients and **increasing the number of subscription sales**.

The subscription model currently used by Beex allows the establishment of recurring relationships with customers and increases customer loyalty and customer lifetime value and reduced churn by making Beex's subscription offerings flexible for better customer retention (Johnson, 2022).

D. Website Traffic

Increase website traffic from Belgium by 25% within the first six months of export to Belgium through **search engine optimization**.

SEO, or search engine optimization, is the process of improving the visibility of a website in search engine results pages, intending to increase the amount of organic traffic that the site receives (Patel, 2020). For Beex's export, SEO can be an important tool for reaching potential customers and increasing brand awareness in the target market in Belgium. By optimizing its website for search engines, the company can increase the chances that its website will appear among the top results when potential customers in the target market search for relevant keywords as this can help to increase the visibility of the company and its products and can make it easier for customers to find and learn about the company's offerings (Hardwick, 2022).

This objective can be measured by website traffic management tools.

E. Building Brand Image: CSR

Improve brand perception among Beex's target audience by 25% within the first 6 months of its export to Belgium through **the incorporation of CSR initiatives** that align with the company's values and the interests of the target audience. This will demonstrate Beex's commitment to responsible and ethical business practices, further enhancing its brand image and reputation.

CEO Bieke has indicated that the company plans to focus on CSR initiatives in the near future (Personal communication, 2022). Furthermore, implementing CSR was identified in the organizational report for Beex as one of the opportunities for the company. This aligns with the growing trend of consumers and other stakeholders prioritizing companies that operate in a socially and environmentally responsible manner (Heyward, 2020). By prioritizing CSR, Beex can improve its brand perception and attract more customers who are looking to support businesses that are making a positive impact on society (Hubbart, 2022). One way in which CSR can improve a company's brand perception is by making the company more appealing to consumers who are increasingly interested in supporting businesses that are making positive contributions to society and the environment "If a company is known for supporting environmental causes or fair labor practices, consumers may be more likely to view the company favorably and choose to do business with them over a company that does not have a strong CSR record." (Vaughan, 2021).

This objective can be measured by surveying for instance.

F. Building Brand Image: Media Coverage

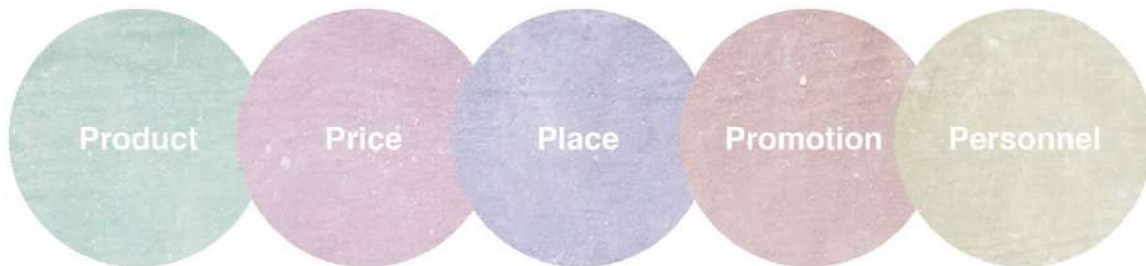
In the first three months of 2023, obtain at least three high-profile media placements for Beex in publications that are pertinent to the industry in order to help **build brand image**, drive **more traffic and sales**, **gain credibility**, and **generate buzz and excitement around Beex's services** (Mollah, 2021).

Obtaining media coverage can increase the visibility and credibility of a business (Oliver, 2022). These placements should be in high-profile publications in order to maximize their impact. This can help to raise Beex's profile within the industry and improve its reputation among potential customers and other stakeholders. "Positive media coverage is a powerful marketing tool because it positions you or your business in a favorable light by projecting the credibility, expertise, passion, and image you want to convey." (Netto, 2021)

This objective can be measured by surveying or social media analysis for instance.

IV. II. Marketing Mix

Marketing Mix



Product/Service

Beex is a marketing and branding agency that provides a wide range of services in social media, public relations, design, content creation, and digital marketing. These services are designed to help businesses build their brand, increase their online presence, and reach their target audience.

They provide their products in the form of monthly subscriptions. This revenue model will still be used in the export country, as mentioned in Chapter II.III. The subscriptions consist of three-monthly packages/subscriptions (Beex, 2022) as follows

- Cool Start aka “Mooie Start” consists of 10 hours per month.
- Ready for Growth aka “Klaar voor Groei” consisting of 20 hours per month.
- Strive for Gold! aka “Ga voor Goud!” consisting of 40 hours per month.

Price

According to Beex's export financial plan for Belgium, there are three types of freelancers who work to fulfill subscription orders from clients. For example, if a client orders a 20-hour monthly package, one or more freelancers must work for that number of hours to produce the desired products for the client. Figure (8) illustrates how three types of freelancers work based on subscription orders (Nr. Of Expected Sales) alongside, variable costs, total costs, and sales prices.

Roles	Nr. of Expected Sales	Variable Costs (per year)	Total Cost (per hour)	Sales Price (per hour)
PR Specialist	801 hours	36,851€	56€	79€
Designer	653 hours	48,116€	60€	84€
Social Media Manager	1131 hours	71,925€	64€	89€

Figure (8)

Beex currently charges **85€** per subscription hour, as they have informed us personally (Personal communication client). According to the example of freelancers working to complete the subscription hours (Figure 8), having a fixed price per subscription hour may not be profitable in all cases, because some employees or freelancers cost more than others, and Beex, in order to

make a profit, cannot charge a client a subscription costing **85€** per hour when multiple entities have to put in the work for these hours and who vary in cost per client. As a result, for each package ordered, Beex should investigate the costs for each client based on their requirements, and then determine the price per subscription hour. In the curated financial plan, the company is estimated to have a revenue of **219649€** and expected sales hours of **2585 hours**, hence the subscription hour remains **85€**. This amount was calculated as an average taking into consideration the expected sales of hours in the first year (total revenue divided by the total number of hours). However, the social media manager and designer are the most expensive in this case; thus, if a client orders an hourly package that requires a social media manager to put in the greatest number of hours, the hourly price should be adjusted to what is most appropriate.

In conclusion, the price of a subscription hour varies depending on variables associated with providing the subscription hours, such as variable costs, revenue projection, and other types of expenses.

Hiring freelancers can be costly. However, even though freelancers may have higher hourly rates than employees, their primary advantage is that clients only pay for the hours they have worked productively. Additionally, freelancers typically use their own equipment, allowing clients to save money (Rühl, 2021).

Place

Beex is set to be exported to Antwerp, Belgium according to the client's preference (Personal communication Beex, 2022). The company's services are primarily targeted at businesses in that region and around. However, Beex may also be able to provide services to businesses in other countries, depending on their needs and capabilities. The company is expected to lease an office in Antwerp, but another option is to start with a shared office space and then decide to lease a full office later.

Promotion

Beex will use a variety of marketing tactics to promote its services, including social media marketing, content marketing, and search engine optimization. The company may also use more traditional marketing tactics such as media coverage in three high-profile outlets and networking with potential clients. Beex may use targeted social media advertising to reach specific demographics or interests and focus on increasing the number of subscription sales by offering incentives or discounts for long-term contracts.

Personnel

Beex's team will include a mix of marketing professionals with expertise in different areas, such as social media management, public relations, design, content creation, and digital marketing. The company's team in Belgium will initially consist of a manager and an assistant. However, they may leverage the expertise of their current team in the Netherlands if it is feasible to do so. The company may also have sales and account management personnel to help clients choose the right services/subscriptions and manage their projects.

IV. III. Legal Implications

The use of targeted social media advertising, partnerships, search optimization, and media coverage are all practices that may have significant legal implications in Belgium. This section aims to examine the legal issues surrounding these practices and to explore the potential legal marketing plan consequences for Beex's export to Belgium. We will examine the legal implications of targeted social media advertising, explore the legal considerations that apply to partnerships, including the rights and obligations of the partners, as well as the impact on clients of the partnership, and legal issues surrounding search optimization, and we will examine the legal considerations that apply to media coverage in Belgium.

Search Optimization

According to Harris (2022), in general, search engine optimization (SEO) is a practice that aims to improve the ranking of a website in search engine results pages (SERPs) in order to increase the visibility and traffic to the website. In Belgium, there are no specific laws that regulate SEO practices. However, SEO practices must adhere to the guidelines and best practices set by search engines, such as Google as these guidelines outline what is and is not acceptable in terms of SEO tactics and techniques and may be updated from time to time (Moore, 2021). In addition, SEO practices must comply with general laws and regulations related to advertising, consumer protection, and privacy (Anderson, 2020). This includes the prohibition of deceptive or misleading advertising practices, the requirement to protect the personal data of users, and the obligation to provide accurate and transparent information about products and services (Addaman, 2019). It is important for individuals and businesses engaging in SEO in Belgium to familiarize themselves with these guidelines and to ensure that their practices comply with them.

Targeted Social Media Advertising

Targeted advertising has been viewed as a violation of privacy due to its use of personal information for the purpose of targeting ads to specific individuals and it is important to recognize that all of the information that is shared online can potentially be tracked and used for targeted advertising (Acrey, 2021). This includes search queries, social media activity, and web browsing history. Advertisers often use this information to infer potential purchasing habits and preferences based on factors such as age, gender, income, and relationship status (GCFGlobal, 2020). However, targeted advertising may be not considered a violation of privacy because it is typically done with the user's consent and when a user visits a website or uses an online service, they often agree to the terms of service, which may include the collection and use of their personal information for targeted advertising purposes as many websites and online services offer users the option to opt-out of targeted advertising by adjusting their privacy settings or using tools like ad blockers (Mertens, 2020)

<https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/thenow/what-is-targeted-advertising/1/>

Partnerships

Partnerships are a type of business structure in which two or more individuals or entities come together to conduct a business venture. In Belgium, partnerships are governed by the Belgian Code of Companies and Associations (Simon, 2020). The legal impacts of partnerships on clients in Belgium depend on the specific terms of the partnership agreement and the nature of the business venture being conducted (Denis, 2021). In general, clients of a partnership in Belgium

have the right to expect that the partnership will act in a professional and transparent manner and that it will adhere to any agreements or contracts that have been made with the client (Nguyen, 2019). The contracting process for partnerships in Belgium involves the creation of a partnership agreement, which outlines the rights, responsibilities, and expectations of the partners. This agreement should be in writing and should be signed by all parties involved. It is important for the partners to carefully review and understand the terms of the partnership agreement before signing it, in order to avoid misunderstandings or disputes in the future (Benali, 2021). Moreover, the legal implications of partnerships in Belgium can be both positive and negative. On the positive side, partnerships can provide a way for businesses to share resources, knowledge, and expertise in order to achieve common goals and they can also provide a way for businesses to expand their operations and reach new markets (Jacobs, 2022). On the negative side, partnerships can be complex and may involve a high level of trust and communication between partners, therefore, in case these elements are not properly managed, partnerships can lead to disputes and even legal action (Weber, 2020).

Media Coverage

There are certain legal considerations that can come into play when it comes to media coverage. In Belgium, media outlets are subject to a number of legal requirements and ethical standards when it comes to the accuracy and fairness of their coverage (Schwarz, 2020). Under Belgian law, media outlets are prohibited from publishing or broadcasting false or misleading information that could harm the reputation of an individual or business and if a media outlet is found to have engaged in deceptive or misleading coverage, it may be subject to legal action, including defamation lawsuits brought by individuals or businesses whose reputation has been damaged by the coverage (Mayr, 2022). It is important for media outlets operating in Belgium to adhere to legal and ethical standards when it comes to their coverage, in order to avoid legal consequences and to maintain the trust of their audiences.

IV. IV. Financial Substantiation

The cost of **targeted social media advertising, partnerships, search optimization, and media coverage in three high-profile media outlets** in Belgium will depend on a number of factors, including the goals of the marketing plan mentioned in Chapter IV.I. Marketing Objectives, the target audience, the budget allocated for the marketing efforts set by Beex, and the resources available to the business. In order to develop a financial substantiation that includes these elements, Beex will need to consider the costs associated with each aspect of the marketing plan and how these costs will be offset by the expected returns on investment (Egger, 2022).

Beex may need to consider the costs of creating and implementing targeted social media advertising campaigns, including the cost of creating ads which Beex will take care of as it's their field of expertise, targeting specific audiences and tracking the effectiveness of the campaigns which are done through social media management tools. The table below (2) shows the costs for different social media platforms (Auer, 2022).

Platform	Cost
Google	An average cost of 2€ - 4€ cost per click.
TikTok	Ads start at 10€ per CPM (cost per thousand).
Instagram	An average cost of 1.18€ cost per click.
Facebook	The average cost per click is about 0.35€ .
YouTube	Ads have an average cost-per-view of 0.010€ – 0.030€ , which likely sums up to an average of 10€ a day.

Table (2)

Beex may also need to consider the costs of partnerships and sponsorships in Belgium, including any **fees** or **commissions** that are paid to partners or sponsors, as well as the cost of any **marketing or promotional efforts** that are undertaken as part of the partnership (Binder, 2020).

In addition, Beex will need to consider the **costs associated with search optimization in Belgium**, including the cost of implementing SEO strategies, such as keyword research and content creation, as well as the cost of any paid search advertising. SEO is also one of Beex's services offered so they may choose to source for this part of the marketing plan in case they would like to outsource it SEOs cost ranges between 50€ - 200€ per hour (Wimmer, 2022).

Finally, Beex will need to consider **the costs of media coverage in Belgium**, including any fees or expenses associated with securing coverage in high-profile media outlets, as well as the cost of any related marketing or promotional efforts (Reiter, 2021).

By carefully considering the costs and potential returns associated with each aspect of the marketing plan in Belgium, Beex can develop a financial substantiation that accurately reflects the costs and benefits of the marketing efforts and helps to guide decision-making and resource allocation (Fischer, 2021).

V. Conclusion

This conclusion chapter aims to summarize the key findings and implications of the research, with the goal of providing clear and concise answers to the central research question and sub questions that were posed. The results of the analysis are presented below.

Central question: How can BEEX successfully export its business to the Belgian market in the year 2023?

In conclusion, successfully exporting Beex to the Belgian market in 2023 will depend on a number of factors, including the development of a comprehensive business plan and export strategy that takes into account the cultural differences, challenges, and opportunities of the Belgian market, as well as the CSR trends in the country. This plan should also include an earnings model and value creation strategy that is tailored to the Belgian market, as well as an operational plan that addresses the internal organization, legal aspects, and CSR strategies of the company in Belgium. Furthermore, Beex's export plan should include marketing objectives that align with the overall export strategy and are aimed at achieving specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound goals. Finally, the export marketing mix should be carefully considered and should include the five Ps of marketing: product, price, promotion, place, and people. By addressing these key issues, Beex can position itself for success in the Belgian market in 2023.

Sub question 1: What will BEEX's business plan and export strategy be, considering the strategic choice of exporting into Belgium, the cultural differences, challenges, and opportunities, as well as the CSR trends in the export country in 2023?

Beex's business plan and export strategy for expanding into Belgium in 2023 will involve taking advantage of opportunities for international expansion, networking and collaboration, and identifying new sources of revenue. Additionally, Beex will focus on prioritizing corporate social responsibility (CSR) efforts, which may help improve its reputation and attract and retain staff and customers. In order to stand out from competitors, Beex will also aim to maintain its reputation as a brand and stay relevant to its customers and industry. To enter the Belgian market, BEEX will consider using the Ansoff growth matrix to analyze its market entry strategy and potential risks. The company will also need to consider cultural differences between Belgium and the Netherlands, as well as any challenges and opportunities related to exporting its services. For example, Beex will need to ensure that it is aware of and compliant with any relevant regulations in Belgium and may need to adapt its business practices and communication style to fit with local cultural norms. Overall, Beex's business plan and export strategy for expanding into Belgium in 2023 will likely involve a combination of identifying and taking advantage of opportunities, adapting to cultural differences, and carefully analyzing and managing any risks and challenges

Sub question 2: How will BEEX's earning model and value creation be impacted by the export to Belgium in 2023?

Beex's revenue model for their export to Belgium will be based on a subscription model. Under this model, customers will pay for access to Beex's products or services on a recurring basis, typically on a monthly or annual basis. The subscription model has several advantages, including reliable recurring revenue, a strong customer base and increased customer loyalty, easier financial forecasting, increased customer lifetime value, and reduced churn. However, the subscription model also carries some risks, including increased competition as more businesses adopt this model.

In terms of value creation, Beex will need to invest in various items such as a physical office, startup costs, and inventory items in order to establish a presence in Belgium. These investments will likely have an impact on the company's overall value creation, as they will help to improve the customer experience and establish a professional image for the company. In addition to these investments, Beex will also need to consider costs such as depreciation, business costs, and salaries in order to operate their business in Belgium. By carefully managing these costs and maximizing the return on its investments, Beex can optimize its revenue model and value creation in the Belgian market.

Sub question 3: What is the BEEX's ideal operational plan, including internal organization, legal aspects, and CSR strategies to realize the export into Belgium in 2023?

Beex will need to deploy a variety of people and resources. This will include hiring employees in Belgium, such as a manager and an assistant, as well as potentially seeking assistance from their current team in the Netherlands. Beex will also need to establish a physical office in Belgium, which will require acquiring equipment and inventory items. Good communication will be important in order to maintain contact with customers and ensure that projects are completed effectively.

In terms of legal implications, Beex will need to consider the various legal requirements for establishing and operating a business in Belgium. This will include choosing the appropriate business structure, such as a limited liability company or open limited liability company, and complying with governance, capital, and shareholder rights requirements. In terms of employment, Beex will need to follow Belgian employment law, including provisions related to minimum wage, working hours, and employee rights. It will also be important to consider any regulatory requirements or permits that may be needed in order to do business in Belgium. By carefully navigating these legal considerations, Beex can ensure that they are operating in compliance with Belgian laws and regulations. When it comes to CSR strategies, Beex will need to consider how it can contribute to the local community and minimize its environmental impact in Belgium. This could involve implementing sustainable business practices, and working with clients that actively engage in CSR. Taking a proactive approach to CSR, Beex can demonstrate its commitment to social and environmental responsibility, which can help to enhance its reputation and build long-term relationships with customers, employees, and other stakeholders.

Sub question 4: Which SMART marketing objectives will BEEX's export plan include, and how will they align with the export strategy for 2023?

To ensure the success of its export plan in 2023, BEEX should include SMART marketing objectives. BEEX might consider setting the following marketing objectives for its export plan:

- A.** Increase brand awareness in Belgium by 30% within the first six months of export through targeted social media advertising.
- B.** Establish partnerships with at least three key industry players in Belgium in 2023 to increase brand visibility and reach potential clients.
- C.** Increase customer satisfaction and retention rates in Belgium in 2023 through high-quality design and content and increasing subscription sales.
- D.** Increase website traffic from Belgium by 25% within the first six months of export through search engine optimization.
- E.** Increase sales in Belgium by 15% within the first six months of export through targeted marketing efforts and partnerships with key industry players.
- F.** Obtain at least three high-profile media placements for Beex in industry-relevant publications in the first three months of 2023 to build brand image, drive traffic and sales, gain credibility, and generate buzz.

By setting clear, measurable, and achievable objectives, Beex can track its progress and make adjustments to its export plan as needed in order to achieve success in the Belgian market in 2023.

Sub question 5: What will BEEX's export marketing mix look like, according to the 5Ps of Marketing, in the year 2023?

Product: Beex is a marketing and branding agency that offers a range of services including social media management, public relations, design, content creation, and digital marketing through the means of monthly subscriptions.

Price: Prices for Beex's subscription-based services will be determined on a case-by-case basis, taking into account the specific requirements and costs of each client.

Place: Beex will be exported to Antwerp, Belgium, and will primarily target businesses in that region.

Promotion: Beex will use a variety of tactics to promote its services, including social media marketing, content marketing, search engine optimization, media coverage in high-profile outlets, and networking with potential clients.

Personnel: Beex's team will include a mix of marketing professionals with expertise in different areas such as social media management, PR, and design among others to help clients choose the right services and manage their accounts.

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